INDEPENDENT COMPETITIVE INTELLIGENCE WORK SAMPLE

Conversational AI in Life Sciences

Competitive landscape and implications for Optum Life Sciences

RWE | Commercial Intelligence | Medical / Regulatory Research | Clinical Trials | Market Access

Outside-in assessment of publicly marketed conversational AI across five Optum LS-relevant business domains

---

Prepared by Joseph Marino

October 2026 · Public sources reviewed as of October 13, 2026

linkedin.com/in/joseph-marino-995651183 · marinojoe@gmail.com

Independent work sample based solely on publicly available information. Not affiliated with, commissioned by or endorsed by Optum or UnitedHealth Group.
Research and drafting were assisted by AI tools; the analysis and conclusions are the author's own.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Conversational AI is being marketed across life sciences workflows, creating new ways to access information, analytics and decision support

OUTSIDE-IN RESEARCH LENS

This study is an assessment of *publicly-marketed* conversational AI products across five Optum Life Sciences-relevant business domains:

RWE | Commercial Intelligence | Medical / Regulatory Research | Clinical Trials and Market Access

The U.S. is the primary competitive focus; selected international offerings provide context; Optum LS anchors the comparisons.

KEY FINDINGS

19 The U.S. screen identified **19 conversational AI offerings** across five business domains, **concentrated in RWE and Commercial Intelligence**.

9 **Nine selected international offerings** show how vendors outside the U.S. position conversational interaction, concentrated in **RWE and Commercial Intelligence**.

OPTUM LS POSITIONING

Optum LS publicly emphasizes linked healthcare data, AI-enabled research tools and scientific expertise.

Several competitors prominently market conversational interfaces as the entry point to comparable customer tasks.

This reflects differences in public positioning, not necessarily in underlying functionality.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION

The competitive significance of conversational AI depends on the customer task, underlying data and reliability of the results.

Where could conversational interaction add value to Optum LS's existing offerings?

RESEARCH CATALYST

Recent product launches in RWE prompted a broader examination of conversational AI across life sciences

SELECTED PUBLIC PRODUCT ANNOUNCEMENTS

2024

Earlier precedents

Tempus's **Tempus One / Lens** — AI-assisted research and cohort exploration (February)

Komodo Health's **MapAI** — conversational healthcare analytics (September)

August 2025

Platform expansion

Komodo Health's **Marmot** — AI-powered healthcare analytics and research workflows

April–May 2026

Research-interface launches

Truveta's **Truveta Intelligence** — natural-language RWE research questions

Flatiron Health's **Telescope** — conversational oncology cohort exploration

September 2026

New releases

Verana Health's **Agent Claire** — conversational specialty-data research

Norstella's **Atlas Patient Analytics** — agentic, managed cohort analytics

THE BROADER COMPETITIVE QUESTION

Where else are life sciences vendors marketing conversational AI, what tasks does it serve, and how does that positioning compare with Optum LS?

OUR RESEARCH RESPONSE

We examine publicly marketed conversational AI across five Optum LS-relevant business domains. Vendors' product claims provide observable evidence for competitive positioning without access to internal product data.

Among U.S. competitors, conversational AI is most prominent in RWE; Optum LS has relevant offerings in all five domains

45 U.S. competitors screened → **15** distinct competitors marketing conversational AI

Competitors marketing conversational AI / Total comparable competitors	Domain	Conversational AI offerings	Relevant Optum LS offerings
9 / 34	RWE	Komodo Marmot and MapAI; Truveta Intelligence; Flatiron Telescope; Tempus Lens; and more	Analytics on Demand; epidemiology research
3 / 23	Commercial Intelligence	IQVIA Field Force Agent and GMI Agent; ZS Conversational AI for Commercial; Trinity InsightsEDGE Digital Twins	Market Clarity: portfolio and patient/prescriber analytics
3 / 18	Medical / Regulatory Research	IQVIA Med-R1; ZS Conversational AI for Medical; Veeva Vault AI Chat	Postapproval safety studies; Market Clarity medical affairs insights
1 / 25	Clinical Trials	TriNetX Terrain AI Assistant	Prospector; Digital Research Network; True Source
1 / 24	Market Access	EVERSANA Ask NAVLIN	HEOR/value evidence; Evidence Engine

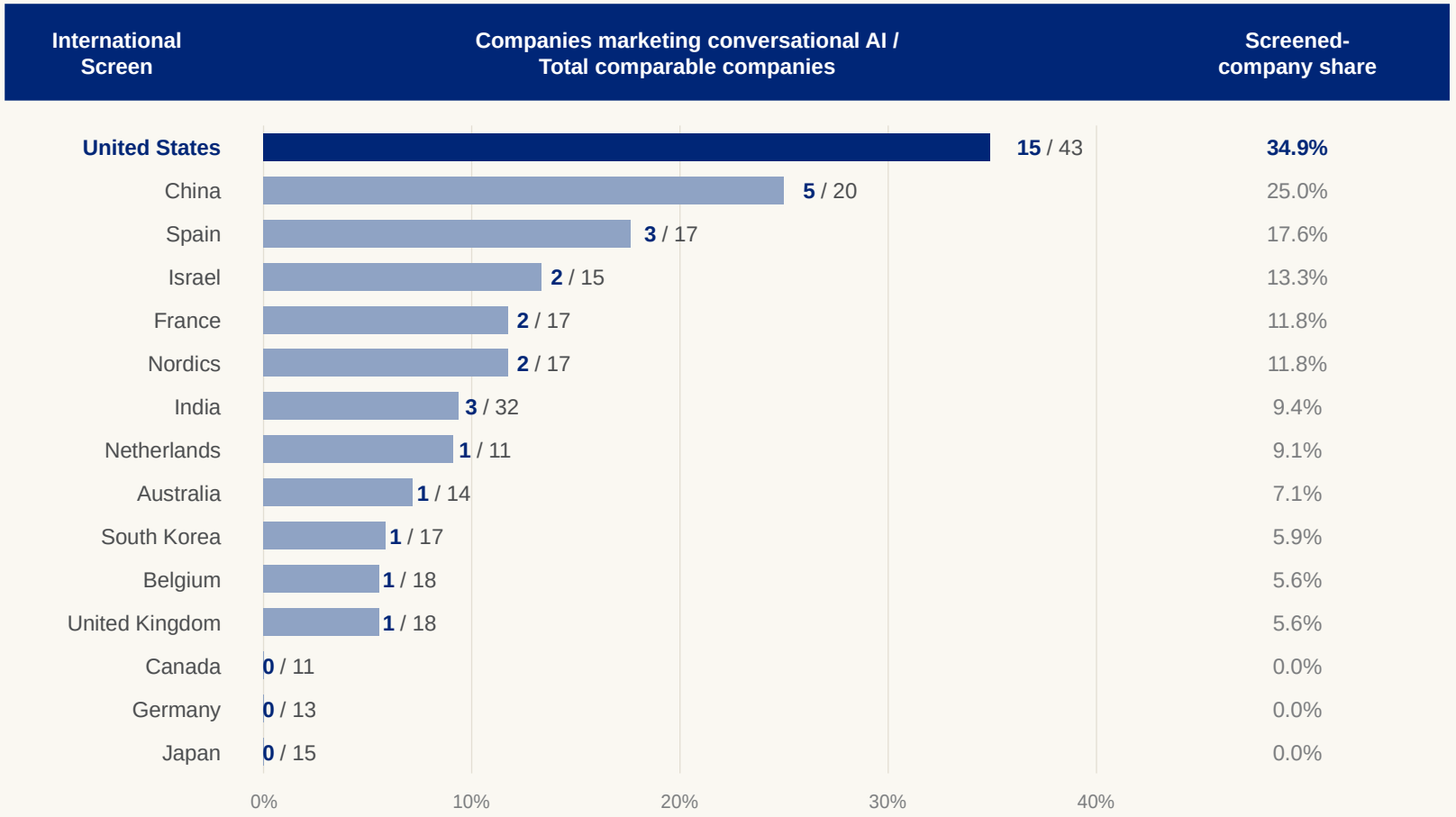
Scope note: Offerings are organized by their primary domain; supporting data and analytics capabilities may serve more than one domain.

KEY TAKEAWAY

A publicly-marketed customer-facing conversational interface was not established in the reviewed materials for Optum LS across the five relevant business domains.

Selected international screens identify additional companies marketing conversational AI across Optum LS-relevant domains

COMPARABLE COMPANIES MARKETING CONVERSATIONAL AI



HOW TO READ THE COMPARISON

Each bar shows the share of comparable companies we screened that market conversational AI. International counts exclude companies already represented in the U.S. inventory.

FROM COMPANY SCREENS TO ACTUAL PRODUCTS

The following slides examine the specific marketed conversational tools and corresponding Optum LS offerings – beginning with RWE.

Competitors are marketing conversational tools to assess healthcare datasets, explore cohorts and answer RWE questions

CUSTOMER TASK	CONVERSATIONAL AI OFFERINGS	RELEVANT OPTUM LS OFFERINGS
Identify and assess suitable data	Truven **MarketScan Snapshot**: Natural-language assessment of MarketScan data suitability; Norstella / Panalgo **Ella AI**: Conversational dataset recommendations (along with cohort construction and documented RWE analysis)	**Market Clarity Data** (linked claims/EHR); **Enriched Clinical Data** (NLP-extracted clinical variables)
Explore patient populations and cohorts	Komodo Health's **Marmot** and **MapAI**: conversational healthcare analytics and cohort exploration; Truveta's **Truveta Intelligence**: natural-language research questions over longitudinal clinical data; Briya's **AIRE Population Agent** (Israel): natural-language cohort eligibility and feasibility assessment	**Analytics on Demand** (advanced statistical models); **Clinical Notes Lab** (NLP/LLMs, custom AI models); **Prospector** (no-code cohort building, attrition analysis)
Investigate broader RWE questions	HealthVerity **eXOs**: Conversational data feasibility, cohort design and auditable RWE analysis; BC Platforms' **BC Catalyst** (Finland): prompt-based cohort building and clinical/genomic research exploration	**Analytics on Demand** (statistical modeling, decision trees); **epidemiology research services** (advanced study methods, scientific review)

END-TO-END CONVERSATIONAL RWE

HealthVerity eXOs and Norstella Ella position conversational AI as the front door to their platforms, spanning dataset assessment, cohort exploration and broader research questions in a single chat workflow.

PRE-ENGAGEMENT DATA EVALUATION

MarketScan Snapshot uses conversational AI as a sales tool as well as an analytics feature, offering qualified prospects free AI access to cohort counts and summary statistics before they commit to a full RWE analysis.

Specialty-data platforms bring conversational AI into oncology research and more narrowly-defined evidence questions

CUSTOMER TASK	CONVERSATIONAL AI OFFERINGS	RELEVANT OPTUM LS OFFERINGS
Explore oncology and specialty cohorts	Flatiron Health's **Telescope**: conversational oncology cohort exploration; Tempus's **Lens**: clinical and molecular research exploration	**Enriched Clinical Data** (NLP-derived disease attributes); **clinicogenomics datasets** (linked clinical/genomic data)
Investigate specialty-disease evidence	ConcertAI's **Precision Explorer**: oncology research analytics; Verana Health's **Agent Claire**: conversational specialty-data research;	**Clinical Notes Lab** (NLP/LLMs, custom AI models); **epidemiology and observational research** (study design, comparative effectiveness)
Analyze curated research datasets	MDClone's **ADAMS Copilot** (Israel): conversational statistical analysis and visualization within controlled research datasets	**Analytics on Demand** (advanced statistical modeling, survival analysis); **research data and study environments** (curated data, analytical workspaces)

WHERE DOES CONVERSATIONAL ANALYSIS END AND SCIENTIFIC EVIDENCE GENERATION BEGIN?

Optum also markets epidemiology studies and Evidence Engine services. The conversational products above are not automatically equivalent to those scientific services.

BEYOND THE PUBLIC EVIDENCE

Which tools support exploratory questions versus reproducible study analyses? What supporting methods, provenance and review can customers inspect? Which capabilities are publicly demonstrated, and which require further validation?

Commercial Intelligence AI products extend conversational interaction into market intelligence, field decisions and simulated stakeholder research

CUSTOMER TASK	CONVERSATIONAL AI OFFERINGS	RELEVANT OPTUM LS OFFERINGS
Pharmaceutical market and portfolio intelligence	IQVIA's **GMI Agent**: global market insights; GBI Health's **GBI BOT** (China): pharmaceutical database Q&A and competitive intelligence; Prospection's **ProGPT** (Australia): conversational patient and market insights for brand planning	**Market Clarity** (linked claims/EHR data, market attractiveness and portfolio analytics)
Commercial field and prescribing decisions	IQVIA's **Field Force Agent**: commercial field support; ZS's **ZAIDYN Conversational AI for Commercial**: commercial information and decision support; Close-Up International's **Xplora AI** (Spain): AI-enabled pharmaceutical CRM and commercial intelligence	**Market Clarity** (patient/prescriber segmentation, treatment patterns, market analytics)
Simulated stakeholder research	Trinity Life Sciences' **InsightsEDGE Digital Twins**: conversational simulated personas; Ipsos's **Healthcare PersonaBot** (France): interaction with simulated healthcare stakeholders	**Market Clarity** (observed patient/prescriber insights); no comparable simulated-persona offering established

BEYOND THE PUBLIC EVIDENCE

Which decisions are these products designed to support? What underlying commercial information can users access? Where does an assistant move beyond analytics into field execution or simulated research?

TRANSITION TO OTHER DOMAINS

How does the comparison change for medical affairs, clinical development and market access, where the intended users, evidence requirements and decisions differ?

Competitors market conversational tools for scientific evidence, medical insights and regulated content workflows

CUSTOMER TASK	CONVERSATIONAL AI OFFERINGS	RELEVANT OPTUM LS OFFERINGS
Search and synthesize scientific evidence	IQVIA's **Med-R1 Deep Research Agent**: synthesizes biomedical, clinical and regulatory sources to answer complex research questions	**Epidemiology research** (study design, RWE generation); **postapproval safety and comparative-effectiveness studies** (statistical analysis)
Explore medical insights and support scientific engagement	ZS's **ZAIDYN Conversational AI for Medical**: natural-language analysis of care gaps, scientific insights and opinion-leader information; Evidenze's **AI medical-education chatbots** (Spain): conversational medical education and knowledge support	**Market Clarity** (medical affairs evidence, MSL insights, HCP analytics)
Question and navigate regulated documents	Veeva's **Vault AI Chat**: questions, summaries and follow-up interactions within authorized Vault documents and records	**Safety and evidence-research services** (scientific analysis); no comparable regulated-document assistant established

BEYOND THE PUBLIC EVIDENCE

Which offerings help users find evidence, and which help them interpret or act on it? What source traceability, permissions and scientific review are built into the marketed experience? Where are these fundamentally different services?

Conversational offerings address specific trial operations and pricing questions, not the entire clinical or market-access workflow

CLINICAL TRIALS — COMPETITIVE EXAMPLES

CUSTOMER TASK	CONVERSATIONAL AI OFFERINGS	RELEVANT OPTUM LS OFFERINGS
Trial feasibility, site and investigator identification	TriNetX's **Terrain AI Assistant**: natural-language questions about trial sites, investigator experience and patient populations	**Prospector** (no-code cohort building, attrition funnels); **Digital Research Network** (patient identification, recruitment infrastructure)
Clinical-trial document operations	Taimei's **Wiz-iCTA** (China): conversational assistant supporting trial project teams and document-management work	**True Source** (electronic source-data capture); no comparable conversational document assistant established

MARKET ACCESS — COMPETITIVE EXAMPLES

CUSTOMER TASK	CONVERSATIONAL AI OFFERINGS	RELEVANT OPTUM LS OFFERINGS
Pharmaceutical pricing and market-access intelligence	EVERSANA's **Ask NAVLIN**: conversational access to pricing, reimbursement and market-access information	**HEOR/value evidence** (outcomes research, economic analysis); **Evidence Engine** (evidence-generation support); **health economic and budget impact modeling** (cost and budget scenarios)

BEYOND THE PUBLIC EVIDENCE

For Clinical Trials, does the interface help identify viable sites, evaluate patients or manage trial documents—and how far does it go?

For Market Access, is the customer asking for pricing intelligence, reimbursement information or new economic evidence? Where do the vendor offerings overlap with Optum LS, and where do they solve a different problem?

ADDITIONAL COMPETITIVE DYNAMIC: LLM PROVIDERS EXPAND INTO LIFE SCIENCES

LLM providers behind conversational AI are expanding into pharmaceutical workflows through partnerships, specialized offerings and acquisitions

THREE OBSERVED APPROACHES TO ENTERING LIFE SCIENCES

LLM PROVIDER APPROACH	SELECTED PUBLIC DEVELOPMENTS	COMPETITIVE SIGNIFICANCE FOR OPTUM LS
Partner with established life-sciences vendors	**Anthropic + Komodo Health:** A documented partnership supporting AI-enabled healthcare analytics; **Anthropic + Veeva:** Claude incorporated into Veeva's industry-specific AI offerings; **AWS + Datavant:** Explore Assistant, publicly described in February 2026, uses Bedrock and AWS Clean Rooms to support natural-language assessment of healthcare datasets and research feasibility.	LLM providers can contribute underlying technology to existing life-sciences platforms while those companies retain specialized data, applications and customer relationships. Komodo and Veeva already appear in our competitive analysis.
Develop their own life-sciences-specific products and tools	**Anthropic's Claude for Life Sciences:** Specialized scientific tools and integrations supporting research, clinical trials and regulatory workflows; **OpenAI's GPT-Rosalind:** A purpose-built model for biology, drug discovery and translational research, with access expanded to eligible organizations in September 2026.	Rather than acting only as technology suppliers, LLM providers are building offerings aimed more directly at life-sciences users. These products are not necessarily direct substitutes for Optum LS's RWE and healthcare-data offerings, but they illustrate potential expansion into adjacent customer workflows.
Acquire specialized life-sciences capabilities	**Cohere + Reliant AI:** In May 2026, Cohere acquired a biopharma AI company offering literature review, competitive landscaping and scientific/regulatory information extraction. The acquisition supports development of North for Pharma, a planned specialized agentic offering.	Acquisitions provide another way for LLM providers to obtain industry-specific technology, expertise and pharmaceutical customer relationships—potentially strengthening their ability to supply or compete with established life-sciences platforms.

STRATEGIC QUESTIONS FOR OPTUM LS

As LLM providers expand beyond supplying general-purpose models, where will they remain technology partners to established life-sciences vendors—and where might they increasingly compete for the same pharmaceutical customers and workflows?

What could these developments mean for the competitive positions of companies whose offerings combine differentiated healthcare data, research tools and scientific expertise?

METHODOLOGY NOTES

SLIDE 2 — EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Public product marketing and announcements reviewed as of October 13, 2026. The findings describe selected screened inventories—not a market census, adoption rates, verified product performance or undisclosed capabilities.

SLIDE 3 — RESEARCH CATALYST

Dates reflect selected public announcements or releases, not necessarily first feature availability. The timeline illustrates a research catalyst, not measured market-wide growth. AI-enabled or agentic launches are not automatically qualifying conversational products; Norstella's Atlas Patient Analytics is excluded from the final conversational count.

SLIDE 4 — U.S. LANDSCAPE

Of 45 groups initially screened, 43 qualified as comparable across the five domains. Included peers are **direct and specialized/partial offering-level competitors** serving similar customer tasks; adjacent participants are excluded. Counts represent distinct company groups per domain, not product totals. A company may appear in multiple domains. These are selected screened companies, not market-wide adoption rates.

SLIDE 5 — INTERNATIONAL SCREENS

Selected country/region screens differ in research depth and company composition and are not representative national market samples. The Nordics screen groups Denmark, Finland, Norway and Sweden. A multinational may appear in multiple country screens; the counts are not additive across countries. A globally marketed product does not establish locally verified use. Percentages show shares within screened comparable companies, not regional adoption, customer penetration or product deployment rates.

SLIDE 6 — RWE

Scope: Six qualifying U.S. conversational offerings plus two selected international examples. Optum offerings are task-level comparators, not established conversational equivalents. Descriptions reflect public marketing, not independently verified performance or data access.

SLIDE 7 — SPECIALIZED RWE

Scope: Four qualifying U.S. conversational offerings plus one selected international example. Product descriptions are based on public marketing; study-grade reliability, data entitlements and actual deployment are not independently established.

METHODOLOGY NOTES (CONT.)

SLIDE 8 — COMMERCIAL INTELLIGENCE

Scope: All four qualifying U.S. commercial conversational offerings plus four selected international examples. Customer tasks are not interchangeable; Optum comparisons are based on public offerings, not feature-for-feature validation. International examples are illustrative, not a geographic prevalence comparison.

SLIDE 9 — MEDICAL / REGULATORY

Three qualifying U.S. offerings plus one selected Spanish example. The examples span distinct tasks; scientific research, medical education, document assistance and pharmacovigilance are not interchangeable. Optum comparisons reflect publicly marketed capabilities, not verified conversational equivalence.

SLIDE 10 — TRIALS & MARKET ACCESS

Clinical trials — one qualifying U.S. offering and one selected Chinese example. Market access — one qualifying U.S. offering. No additional qualifying international market-access offering was identified in the selected inventory. The Optum comparisons are based on customer-task overlap, not identical product functionality.

SLIDE 11 — LLM PROVIDERS

These are selected publicly documented developments, not an exhaustive assessment of LLM providers. The three approaches are neither mutually exclusive nor predictions of future competition. They do not establish that LLM providers caused the recent RWE launch cluster, are displacing established vendors, or expose an Optum capability gap. Not all LLM provider offerings qualify as conversational products; they are not additions to the deck's product counts. North for Pharma was described as planned; Explore Assistant's general commercial availability was not established in our review.

PUBLIC-SOURCE LINK CONVENTION

Named products, offerings and developments link directly to public vendor documentation or announcements. Quantitative findings are independent screening and classification results, not externally published statistics. Independent work sample; not commissioned by or affiliated with Optum.